

Richard Yanaky

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[Google Scholar](#) | [ORCID](#) | [LinkedIn](#)
[Research Profile](#) | [City Ditty](#)

Research Profile

Researcher in human-computer interaction and Information Studies exploring how interactive and immersive systems can build capacity to understand complex issues, imagine alternatives, and translate specialized knowledge into practice.

Research Areas: Human-computer interaction; interactive and immersive systems; virtual reality; human-soundscape interaction; knowledge translation.

Education

- 2018–present** PhD Candidate, Information Studies, McGill University
Dissertation title: Bridging the Academic Practice Gap through Technology: Immersive Soundscape Planning. Expected Defence: December 2026. Supervisor: Professor Catherine Guastavino.
- 2014–2015** PhD studies, Speech and Language, MARCS Institute for Brain, Behaviour and Development, University of Western Sydney (now Western Sydney University)
Research topic: Implementing a Hierarchical Learning System of Sound and Language.
- 2011–2013** MSc in Linguistics, University of Alberta
Thesis: Modeling the fuzzy factors of speech: With experimental data from emphatic speech. Supervisors: Professors Benjamin Tucker and Robert Kirchner.
- 2008–2011** Specialized Honours BA in Linguistics, York University — Dean's Honour Roll
- 2003–2006** Advanced Diploma in Computer Programming and Analysis, Seneca College — specialization in databases

Academic Appointments

- 2020–present** Occasional Instructor, School of Information Studies, McGill University
- 2015–2018** Professor (part-time faculty), Applied Computing, Faculty of Applied Science & Technology, Sheridan College

Publications and Scholarly Outputs

Journal Articles

Yanaky, R., Tyler, D., & Guastavino, C. (2023). City Ditty: An immersive soundscape sketchpad for professionals of the built environment. *Applied Sciences*, 13(3), 1611. <https://doi.org/10.3390/app13031611>

Book Chapters

Yanaky, R., Reimer, P. J. C., Fraise, V., Wanderley, M., & Guastavino, C. (2024). Sound-based interaction. In C. Stephanidis & G. Salvendy (Eds.), *Human computer interaction: Interaction technologies and techniques*. CRC Press. [Publisher page](#)

Peer-Reviewed Conference and Workshop Papers

- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2025, Nov 12-14). Virtual Reality for Urban Soundscape Design: Exploring knowledge sharing, creation, and workplace integration. Demo and poster presented at the 31st ACM Symposium on Virtual Reality Software and Technology, Montreal, Canada. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3756884.3768399>
- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2024). Realistic enough? Design considerations for soundscape simulators. *Canadian Acoustics*, 52(1). <https://jcaa.caa-aca.ca/index.php/jcaa/article/view/4183> **Second Place Paper/Presentation Award in Architectural Acoustics, Acoustical Society of America.**
- Fraise, V., Tarlao, C., Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2024). One size doesn't fit all: Three tools for soundscape simulation. *Canadian Acoustics*, 52(1). <https://jcaa.caa-aca.ca/index.php/jcaa/article/view/4180>

- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2023). Bridging the gap between sound and non-sound professionals with virtual reality. *Canadian Acoustics*, 51(3). <https://jcaa.caa-aca.ca/index.php/jcaa/article/view/4064>
- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2022). Addressing transdisciplinary challenges through technology: Immersive soundscape planning tools. The Annual Conference of CAIS/Actes du congrès annuel de l'ACSI. <https://doi.org/10.29173/cais1257>
- Yanaky, R., Tarlao, C., & Guastavino, C. (2020). An interactive soundscape simulator for professionals of the built environment. Paper presented at the International Workshop on Haptic and Audio Interaction Design, HAID 2020, Montreal, QC, Canada. <https://hal.science/HAID2020/hal-02901211v1>

Conference Proceedings Papers — Abstract-Reviewed

Full papers published in conference proceedings; acceptance based on peer review of submitted abstracts.

- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2026, September 8–12). Translating Soundscapes into Practice Using Virtual Reality: City Makers' Insights on Interactive Soundscape Simulation. Documenta of Forum Acusticum 2026. Forum Acusticum 2026, Graz, Austria. **Invited paper.** [Preprint](#)
- Yanaky, R., Toffa, S., & Guastavino, C. (2026, September 8–12). Interacting with soundscapes in Virtual Reality: desktop vs. immersive VR. Documenta of Forum Acusticum 2026. Forum Acusticum 2026, Graz, Austria. **Invited paper.** [Preprint](#)
- Kogan, P., Fuentes, L., Yanaky, R., Verdugo, D., Saavedra, I., Monsalve, J., Hidalgo, P., Vega, B., Bild, E., & Guastavino, C. (2026, September 8–12). From Soundwalks to Auralisation: A Participatory Workflow for Biophilic Soundscape Design in Urban Green Spaces Using City Ditty. Documenta of Forum Acusticum 2026. Forum Acusticum 2026, Graz, Austria. [Preprint](#)
- Yanaky, R., Fuentes, L., Verdugo, D., Monsalve, J., Vega, B., Villavicencio, C., Kogan, P., & Guastavino, C. (2025, August 24–27). Application of the City Ditty soundscape tool in an interdisciplinary urban park design competition. INTER-NOISE and NOISE-CON Congress and Conference Proceedings, 272(1), 3639–3650. São Paulo, Brazil. https://doi.org/10.3397/IN_2025_1095787 · [Free full text](#)
- Yanaky, R., Grazioli, G., Zhang, KYY., & Guastavino, C. (2023, August 20–23). Exploring the use of soundscape sketchpads with professionals. INTER-NOISE and NOISE-CON Congress and Conference Proceedings, Chiba, Japan. https://doi.org/10.3397/IN_2023_0322 · [Free full text](#)

Peer-Reviewed Conference Abstracts

- Miao, C., Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2025, May 27–30). Effect of music on the Quality of Urban Public Experience: a virtual reality experiment. 56th Annual Conference of the Environmental Design Research Association (EDRA), Halifax, Nova Scotia. https://www.researchgate.net/publication/390805961_Effect_of_music_on_the_Quality_of_Urban_Public_Experience_a_virtual_reality_experiment
- Yanaky, R. (2019). Predicting emphatic speech: Classification of non-literal utterance. Paper presented at the 13th International Conference on Advances in Quantitative Laryngology, Voice and Speech Research, Montreal, QC, Canada. http://aql2019.conference.mcgill.ca/AQL%20Abstract%20book_2019.pdf

Research Reports

- Fraisse, V., Tarlao, C., Trudeau, C., Imani, N., Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2025). Prise en compte du sonore dans les interfaces entre les activités industrielles-portuaires et les activités résidentielles de Mercier–Hochelaga-Maisonneuve. [Translation: Consideration of noise in the interfaces between industrial port activities and residential activities in Mercier – Hochelaga-Maisonneuve]. *Ville Sonore, École des sciences de l'information, Université McGill* (pp.1-263).

Research Funding, Fellowships and Awards

Research Funding

2022	College Technology Transfer Centre Grant (CCTT), Fonds de recherche du Québec – Nature et technologies (FRQNT) — \$7,000
2021	College Technology Transfer Centre Grant (CCTT), Fonds de recherche du Québec – Nature et technologies (FRQNT) — \$7,000
2020	CIRMMT Student Research Award — \$3,500
2020	CIRMMT Agile Seed Funding (co-applicant) — \$1,500

Fellowships and Scholarships

2023–2024	Wolfe Chair Graduate Fellowship in Scientific and Technological Literacy, McGill University Faculty of Arts — \$8,570
2020–2022	FRQSC Doctoral Grant, Fonds de recherche du Québec – Société et culture — \$49,000 — https://doi.org/10.69777/290671

2019	Graduate Excellence Award, School of Information Studies, McGill University — \$10,000
2018	Arthur C. Tagge Scholarship, Faculty of Arts, McGill University — \$9,700
2014–2017	MARCS PhD Scholarship, University of Western Sydney — A\$105,000 nominal award; held 2014–2015
2014–2017	International student tuition and fees waiver, University of Western Sydney — A\$75,000 nominal value; held 2014–2015
2013	Graduate Student Scholarship, Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta — \$5,000
2011	Queen Elizabeth II Graduate Scholarship, Province of Alberta / University of Alberta — \$10,000

Honours and Awards

2024	Best Presentation Award, Congrès du Réseau AIRS — \$300
2024	Second Place Paper/Presentation Award in Architectural Acoustics, Acoustical Society of America — US\$200
2023	Best Poster Award, CIRMMT/OIRCM/BRAMS Student Symposium — \$500
2022	Best Paper/Presentation Award by a PhD Student, EBSI-SIS Student Symposium in Information Science — \$100
2019	Graduate Excellence Award for early completion of comprehensive examination, School of Information Studies, McGill University — \$500

Conference Travel Support

CIRMMT — six conference travel awards, \$4,600 total: VRST 2025 (Montreal), \$175; INTER-NOISE 2025 (São Paulo), \$425; ACM COMPASS 2025 (Toronto), \$600; ASA / Acoustics Week in Canada 2024 (Ottawa), \$600; INTER-NOISE 2023 (Chiba), \$1,200; Urban Sound Symposium 2023 (Barcelona), \$1,600.

McGill Post-Graduate Students' Society (PGSS) — one travel award: ASA / Acoustics Week in Canada 2024 (Ottawa), \$750.

School of Information Studies, McGill University — one travel award: Acoustics Week in Canada 2023 (Montreal), \$280.

Faculty of Arts, McGill University — one Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel (GREAT) Award: INTER-NOISE 2023 (Chiba), \$1,500.

Graduate Students' Association, University of Alberta — one professional development/travel award: Acoustics Week in Canada 2012 (Banff), \$600.

Knowledge Mobilization and Professional Development Support

2025	AIRS Technical Sheet Award — \$1,500
2024	ASA School, Living in the Acoustic Environment — approximately \$2,000 value
2017	Professional Development Grant, Sheridan College — \$1,000

Teaching Experience

1,400+ hours of in-class teaching experience as primary instructor across college and university settings.

McGill University — School of Information Studies

2020–2022	Occasional Instructor • GLIS657 — Database Design and Development ×2 • GLIS634 — Web Systems Design and Management
2019	Teaching Assistant • GLIS657 — Database Design and Development • GLIS692 — Data Science

Sheridan College — Applied Computing

- 2015–2018** Professor (part-time faculty), Faculty of Applied Science & Technology
- DBAS27198 — Database Design and Implementation ×6
 - DBAS32100 — RDBMS Application Development ×2
 - SYST15892 — Interactive User Interface Design ×2
 - SYST13416 — LINUX/UNIX Operating Systems ×2
 - INFO20172 — IT Project Management using PMP ×3
 - SYST10049 — Web Development ×4
 - SYST10199 — Web Programming ×3
 - PROG10082 — Object Oriented Programming 1 – JAVA ×3
 - PROG20016 — Applied C Programming ×3

University of Alberta — Department of Linguistics

- 2011–2013** Teaching Assistant
- LING101 — Introduction to Linguistics ×2
 - LING205 — Phonetics ×2

York University — Linguistics Students Association

- 2010–2011** Linguistics Tutor — undergraduate tutoring across introductory through advanced linguistics courses

Research Mentoring

Undergraduate research mentor — two McGill Cognitive Science thesis students; substantial informal mentoring through project development and execution.

Doctoral research mentor/collaborator — two junior PhD researchers: a visiting researcher from China and a remote collaborator at the University of Chile.

Presentations and Research Dissemination

Invited Talks

Yanaky, R. (2024, February 29). A human-information approach to creating tools for better sound planning. School of Information Studies, McGill University, Montreal, QC.

Conference Presentations

Yanaky, R. (2026). Extensible by Design, Unsustainable by Structure: Interdisciplinarity and Transition in Graduate Design Research. EduCHI, Toronto, Canada. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.11011.87845>

Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2024, November). Using virtual reality to integrate sound considerations in city-making. Congrès du Réseau AIRS 2024, Montreal, QC, Canada. **Best presentation award.**

Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2023). Using immersive planning tools to reimagine virtual libraries. The Annual Conference of CAIS/Actes du congrès annuel de l'ACSI.

Yanaky, R. (2022, March). Addressing transdisciplinary challenges through technology: Immersive soundscape planning tools. Paper presented at the 14th annual EBSI-SIS Student Symposium in Information Science, Montreal, QC, Canada. **Best presentation award.**

Yanaky, R. (2021, May). Educating professionals of the built environment in soundscape design through an immersive virtual reality tool pt. 2. Paper presented at the 3rd CIRMMT/OIRCM/BRAMS Student Symposium, Montreal, QC, Canada.

Yanaky, R., & Zhang, K. (2020, April). Educating professionals of the built environment in soundscape design through an immersive virtual reality tool. Paper presented at the 2nd CIRMMT/OIRCM/BRAMS Student Symposium, Montreal, QC, Canada.

Conference Posters

Yanaky, R. and Guastavino, C. (2025, July 22-25). From Emerging Issue to Design Imperative: Sound, Health, and Human-Centered Cities. Poster presented at ACM COMPASS, Toronto, Canada. <https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.28391.61600>

Tarlao, C., Laplace, J., Fraisse, V., Bild, E., Steele, D., Trudeau, C., Yanaky, R., Di Croce, N., & Guastavino, C. (2024, February). Le sonore, c'est important? Poster presented at the Congrès du Réseau AIRS 2024, Montréal, QC, Canada.

Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2023, March). City Ditty – First evaluations of a new virtual reality soundscape sketchpad [Poster presentation]. 5th CIRMMT/OIRCM/BRAMS Student Symposium, Montreal, QC, Canada. **Best poster award.**

- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2023, April). City Ditty – First evaluations of a new immersive audio-visual soundscape sketchpad. Urban Sound Symposium, Barcelona, Spain.
- Yanaky, R., & Guastavino, C. (2021, April 19–21). Soundscape design tools for professionals [Poster presentation]. Urban Sound Symposium 2021, Ghent, Montreal, Nantes, Zurich, Berlin, London (Online).
- Bild, E., Steele, D., Yanaky, R., Tarlao, C., Di Croce, N., & Guastavino, C. (2021, April 19–21). Sound fundamentals for professionals of the built environment: A course for citymakers [Poster presentation]. Urban Sound Symposium 2021, Ghent, Montreal, Nantes, Zurich, Berlin, London (Online).

Workshop Presentations

- Yanaky, R. & Guastavino, C. (2023). City Ditty: A Soundscape Interaction Tool for Non-Sound Professionals. Presented at the Workshop on Sound Focus in Video Games, February 6, 2023, Montreal Canada.
- Yanaky, R. (2020). Online Teaching Strategies. Presented at the 5th Interact@CIRMMT workshop.

Panels

- Negar Imani (Organizer). (2024, November 25). Panel discussion on Abstract Writing for Scientific. Workshop co-organized by McGill Writing Centre and the McGill Chapter of ASIS&T. Panelists: Vera Granikov, Richard Yanaky, & Kartikay Chadha.
- Yanaky, R. (2022). Motivating a Professional Audience to Action. Panel: Informing the Social World, at the Annual Conference of CAIS/Actes du congrès annuel de l'ACSI.

Selected Professional and Applied Research Experience

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| 2024–2025 | Soundscape Modelling Consultant, City of Montreal collaborative research project
Participated in an applied collaboration concerning industrial-port and residential sound issues, contributing to fieldwork and exploratory soundscape modelling and developing a preliminary virtual representation as part of the project. |
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Academic Service

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| 2025–2026 | Interim Chair, Equity Diversity Inclusion (EDI) Committee, Centre for Interdisciplinary Research in Music Media and Technology (CIRMMT) |
| 2023–present | Member, Equity Diversity Inclusion (EDI) Committee, CIRMMT |
| 2022 | PhD Representative, Faculty Search Committee, School of Information Studies, McGill University |
| 2019–2020 | Chair, ASIS&T McGill Chapter |
| 2019–2020 | PhD Representative, Curriculum Committee, School of Information Studies, McGill University |
| 2019–2020 | PhD Representative, McGill Information Studies Student Association |
| 2018–2019 | Treasurer & Chair-Elect, ASIS&T McGill Chapter |
| 2015 | Organizer, Speech, Language, and Acquisition Research Group, MARCS Institute |
| 2012–2013 | Colloquium Organizer, University of Alberta |
| 2010–2011 | Co-President, Linguistics Students Association, York University |

Peer Review

Reviewer, npj Acoustics

Research Affiliations

- Multimodal Interaction Lab, McGill University
- Centre for Interdisciplinary Research in Music Media and Technology (CIRMMT)
- Sounds in the City cross-sector partnership
- AIRS thematic network (Air, Intersectoriality, Respiratory and Sound Research)

Additional Training

- 2023** Certificate, Quebec Scientific Entrepreneurship Program, V1 Studio, Concordia University — science entrepreneurship skills
- 2020** Strategic Planning Certificate, McGill Executive Institute
- 2017–2018** Certificate, Data Sciences, University of Toronto – St George Campus — statistics, big data management and tools, and introductory machine learning

Media and Public Engagement

- Researcher spotlight** — Young Acousticians Network, European Acoustics Association — <https://www.cirmmt.org/en/news/yanaky-guastavino-awards-2024/yanaky-newsletter-excerpt>
- Podcast** — Yonge and Dundas, S1E24 (2020): “Professor Richard Yanaky: Immersive Technologies, Professional Tools, and The Influence of Sound” — <https://open.spotify.com/episode/4QFu6iPzdbRk9bpLJ0kvDL>

Selected Earlier Professional Experience

- 2015** Linguist, Appen — developed lexicons and phonetic inventories, researched linguistic structures, coordinated native-speaker data, and cleaned/organized language data.
- 2010–2013** Private Consulting and System Design — phonetic consulting; design and implementation of custom interactive web surveys and databases for academic research.
- 2012** Editorial Assistant, Linguistics Abstracts Online (Wiley-Blackwell) — reviewed and categorized journal content.